

Vim Game

User Manual

Project: Vim Game
Study Year: SS2026 – Semester 2
Version: 1.0
Date: 2026-06-22

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1. What is Vim Game?

Vim Game is a browser-based learning game that teaches you how to use Vim — a fast and powerful text editor used by developers worldwide. Instead of reading a manual about Vim, you play your way through it.

You control a character on a 2D map and navigate using real Vim keyboard commands. The map is a practice playground where you can freely explore movement and text navigation at your own pace.

No prior knowledge of Vim is required — the game starts from scratch and guides you step by step.

2. Getting Started

2.1 Creating an Account

To save your progress, you need a free account.

1. Open the application in your browser
2. Click Register in the navigation bar
3. Enter your email address and choose a password
4. Confirm to create your account

Your progress is automatically saved to your account.

2.2 Logging In

1. Click Login in the navigation bar
2. Enter your email and password
3. Click Login — you will be taken directly to the game

2.3 Logging Out

Click your profile icon or name in the navigation bar and select Logout. Your progress is saved automatically before logout.

3. Navigating the Application

The application has the following pages, accessible via the navigation bar:

Page	What it does
Game	The main practice map — start here
Commands	Full reference list of all Vim commands in the game

4. The Practice Map

4.1 What You See

When you open the game, you land on a 2D tile-based map. Your character is placed inside a world made of text — the tiles represent individual characters, just like lines in a text editor. You navigate through this world using Vim commands.

The map starts with a greeting and short text passages that are perfect for practising word-by-word navigation.

4.2 Modes

Like real Vim, the game has two modes that change what your keypresses do:

Mode	How to activate	What it does
Normal Mode	Default on start	Move and navigate — all keys are commands
Insert Mode	Press 'i' or 'a'	Type text into the map

The current active mode is always shown on screen. When in doubt, you are in Normal Mode.

4.3 Movement Commands

All movement commands work in Normal Mode.

Basic Movement — one tile at a time:

Key	Direction
h	Left
j	Down
k	Up
l	Right

Word Movement — jump across text:

Key	Action
w	Jump forward to the start of the next word or symbol group
b	Jump back to the start of the current or previous word (symbols count as words)
B	Jump back to the start of the current or previous word (symbols ignored)
e	Jump forward to the end of the current or next word (symbols count as words)
E	Jump forward to the end of the current or next word (symbols ignored)

4.4 Text Interaction

In Insert Mode you can type directly into the map. Characters are inserted at your current position and the existing text shifts to make room. Switching to Insert Mode is done with 'i' (insert before cursor) or 'a' (insert after cursor).

To return to Normal Mode, press Escape.

4.5 Tiles

The map is made up of different tile types that affect where you can move:

Tile	Walkable?	Description
Ground	Yes	Regular walkable tile — most text sits on ground tiles
Wall	No	Solid obstacle — your character cannot enter
Danger	Yes	Walkable but may have an effect
Empty	—	Blank space beyond the text content

5. Commands Reference

The Commands page (accessible from the navigation bar) lists every Vim command currently available in the game with a short explanation. Use it as a cheat sheet while you are getting started.

6. Glossary

Term	Definition
Vim	A keyboard-driven text editor — in the game, its commands are your controls
Normal Mode	Default mode — all keys trigger movement or commands
Insert Mode	Typing mode — keys enter text into the map, activated with 'i' or 'a'
Tile	A single square on the map, representing one character
Chunk	A section of the map that loads as you explore
Word	A sequence of letters/numbers, or a group of symbols — relevant for w, b, B, e, E